

trenches, so to speak, dealing with the wild, unpredictable nature of how real people respond to greed and fear. No one is always right, but you cannot accuse Barry of pontificating from an ivory tower.

The result is what so many people want and need out of financial commentary: The feeling that you're having a casual beer with an experienced, wise, and honest friend.

Back in Vancouver, Barry spoke about being bearish on China—a controversial point at the time. Asked why, other speakers would launch into a garble of buzzwords and theories. Barry leaned into the mic and, in a whisper, told the audience, “*Psst, they're communists.*”

What I love about Barry's work is that he views investing as a game of emotions and behavior, rather than one driven by intelligence and data. That's important, because a) it's accurate and b) behavior is messy (if not sloppy), unpredictable, varies from person to person, and—unlike data—doesn't pretend to offer a simple answer. Understanding how our behavior makes us do wrong can be more valuable than data purporting to show us how to do right.

This book offers just that, and I think you'll enjoy it as much as I have.

Morgan Housel

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